
HTML Forms

Ref: <https://www.w3schools.com/> and
other internet based tutorials

HTML form

■ The <form> Element

- The HTML <form> element defines a form that is used to collect user input:

<form>

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form elements

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</form>

- An HTML form contains form elements.
- Form elements are different types of input elements, like text fields, checkboxes, radio buttons, submit buttons, and more.

■ The <input> Element

- The <input> element is the most important form element.
- The <input> element can be displayed in several ways, depending on the type attribute.
- Here are some examples:

Type	Description
<input type="text">	Defines a one-line text input field
<input type="radio">	Defines a radio button (for selecting one of many choices)
<input type="submit">	Defines a submit button (for submitting the form)

■ Text Input

- `<input type="text">` defines a one-line input field for text input:
- Example

`<form>`

First name:`<br>`

`<input type="text" name="firstname"> <br>`

Last name:`<br>`

`<input type="text" name="lastname">`

`</form>`

■ Radio Button Input

- `<input type="radio">` defines a radio button.
- Radio buttons let a user select ONE of a limited number of choices:
- Example

`<form>`

`<input type="radio" name="gender" value="male" checked>`
`Male<br>`

`<input type="radio" name="gender" value="female">`
`Female<br>`

`<input type="radio" name="gender" value="other"> Other`
`</form>`

■ The Submit Button

- `<input type="submit">` defines a button for submitting the form data to a form-handler.
- The form-handler is typically a server page with a script for processing input data. The form-handler is specified in the form's action attribute:
- Example

```
<form action="/action_page.php">
```

```
First name:<br>
```

```
<input type="text" name="firstname" value="Mickey"><br>
```

```
Last name:<br>
```

```
<input type="text" name="lastname" value="Mouse"><br><br>
```

```
<input type="submit" value="Submit">
```

```
</form>
```

■ The Target Attribute

- The target attribute specifies if the submitted result will open in a new browser tab, a frame, or in the current window.
- The default value is "_self" which means the form will be submitted in the current window.
- To make the form result open in a new browser tab, use the value "_blank":
- Example
- `<form action="/action_page.php" target="_blank">`

■ The Method Attribute

- The method attribute specifies the HTTP method (GET or POST) to be used when submitting the form data:
 - Example
 - `<form action="/action_page.php" method="get">`
 - or:
 - Example
 - `<form action="/action_page.php" method="post">`
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■ When to Use GET?

- The default method when submitting form data is GET.
- However, when GET is used, the submitted form data will be visible in the page address field:
- `/action_page.php?firstname=Mickey&lastname=Mouse`
- Notes on GET:
 - ❑ Appends form-data into the URL in name/value pairs
 - ❑ The length of a URL is limited (about 3000 characters)
 - ❑ Never use GET to send sensitive data! (will be visible in the URL)
 - ❑ GET is better for non-secure data, like query strings in Google

■ When to Use POST?

- Always use POST if the form data contains sensitive or personal information. The POST method does not display the submitted form data in the page address field.
 - Notes on POST:
 - POST has no size limitations, and can be used to send large amounts of data.
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■ The Name Attribute

- Each input field must have a name attribute to be submitted.
- If the name attribute is omitted, the data of that input field will not be sent at all.
- This example will only submit the "Last name" input field:
- Example

```
<form action="/action_page.php">
```

```
  First name:<br>
```

```
  <input type="text" value="Mickey"><br>
```

```
  Last name:<br>
```

```
  <input type="text" name="lastname" value="Mouse"><br><br>
```

```
  <input type="submit" value="Submit">
```

```
</form>
```